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THE POEMS OF SU TUNG-P'O: CATCHES AND LOSSES IN THE NET OF TRANSLATION

Gordon T. Osing

1

The following represents a work of scholarship or criticism not so much as an experiment, an attempt anyway, at rendering the poems of Su Tung-p'o as poems in English. The project was initiated in the winter of 1986-87 while I was teaching as an exchange professor at Huazhong Normal University in Wuhan, Hubei Province, in the People's Republic of China. My post-graduate student Min Xiao-hong came to me with her own enthusiasm for the great Sung Dynasty poet and suggested we try our hand at putting the poems into English. I had a desire to learn what I could about the poetics of Classical Chinese poetry and rather liked the literary personality of Su Shi for his very human feelings and his frankness. Later I learned to respect his masteries and uses of old poetic forms to contain those lively matters.

Of course, this sort of thing has been done, numerous times, and by people with scholarly credentials more real than mine. (Theirs could hardly have been less.) But there were interests that drew me to the project anyway. In fact, I had not been always satisfied with the renderings of Chinese poems in English. They seemed self-consciously sparse, like some kind of austere free verse, bad Sandburg in other words. Even Ezra Pound's renderings, confessedly largely reinvented, seemed to be lacking some sense of the Chinese artist's loyalty to received forms, his participation in the ongoing historical salon of the art form and the culture. It seemed to me the Classical authors played their poetic games inside a small and demanding space, in spite of the variety of their expressions and achievements.

Three things drew me to try my hand at it anyway: Min Xiao-hong is bright and nearly bi-lingual and related to me with unusual openness and frankness and could tell me when I hit and why I didn't hit the marks with my phrasings; I felt I had certain advantages because I am a poet myself; I had the freedom to invent equivalent poems, taking some chances and reworking the syntactical parts of the originals rather than being obligated to capture a word for word literal translation. That kind of work struck me as resulting in what we used to call in classical

languages classes the invention of a pony, not the same thing at all as a finished artifact. Perhaps such a pony can be the internal skeleton of finished work, and certainly it is a necessary intermediate stage of translating. But the essential matters surround the question: Which does one want, finally, a set of rough cultural evidences or a work possessing an attendant polish like the original?

Min Xiao-hong had begun bringing me Su Shi poems on rainy Sunday afternoons, and it rains a lot in the winter/springtimes in Hubei Province. Her former professor at Huangang Teachers University, Huang Hai-peng, is a Su Shi scholar and helped her make a selection of the poems generally considered the best if not most central to his artistic career. He and she worked up fifty poems, printing beneath the original characters a character by character (or phrase by phrase) English pony. They set in the pinyin for each Chinese character, to assist the Western reader who might wish to try his hand at reading the poems out loud. To these he and she added notes for each allusion to a historical or mythological or cultural matter and a set of remarks guiding the reader to broader 'readings' of the poems, called 'appreciations.'

One attraction of the project for me was prosopopoeic. I wanted to make Su Shi live in English as immediately and humanly as he lives in his original poems. I hasten to add that I have worked in and around translation projects enough to know that total victory in translation is next to impossible. The best translations fall short, interestingly, or daringly, or cleverly, in brief, in terms that feature one or several aspects of the original but do not fully embody it. I could see early on in our project that that would be the case with our work. That's why I prefer to talk about equivalent poems, or transliterations, or even reinventions, rather than close translation. Especially Chinese poetry is made by representational means and a poem rhetoric that do not exist in English and its literary culture. Let me say what numerous of you already know. A Chinese poem exists as an image/character text with only word order to suggest syntax, and without inflections to guide grammatical meanings, plurals, tenses, etcetera. The poet offers instead separate metonymies with somewhat unspecified (in comparison with poetry in English) relationships, often with a view to making the resultant ambiguity a lively core of meanings; he includes stock epithets; he presumes a scholarly reader's receptivity to numerous historical matters, and to artistic and cultural histories. The poem's text is richly encoded, in other words, and the act of reading is the same as the act of recreating the poem within one's own being. One lives the poem while reading it. Understanding and interpreting are not at the heart of the matter. Nevertheless, real learning and artistic preparation are necessary for this kind of reading, which would appear to be class-learning conscious to a serious degree, as if to say the language and the art of that language exist deliberately at some distance from common uses. The reader participates in the highest intellections and privileges and privacies the culture offers. The past, and the language and the poet's present moment of experience gather into one another. On the back side of some imagined circle or continuum of culture, the classical author uses folk and ballad and popular tunes to contain these comparatively esoteric emotional knowings. The

language of the art contains the limits and hierarchies of human feeling and the culturally learned one reads to find those learnings reenacted and embodied as poetry.

One begins to speculate on contrasts between Chinese and English language poetries, and one by one the generalizations become suspect or fall beneath elaborate qualifications. A strange, present-tense immediacy describes both, as if to say, to read a poem correctly is to live it for a while. And then come the devices of the art, both arts, to weave delays and multiple meanings that take the knowing moments into the culture's past, indeed, into the world of the language's past. The poem embodies a combination of fresh and correct moves, within the rules of consciousness that are the qualities of the language, unacknowledged legislation if ever we heard of it.

More importantly, we realize the preeminence of the plane of language itself in the generation of a poem, the written and assumed characters and figures already in the past of the poetry the author puts down freshly. Contrast this with Wordsworth's and Coleridge's expectations for their *Lyrical Ballads*, and with T.S. Eliot's suggestion that our poetry needs to refresh itself at new wells of consciousness every few generations. Contrast this with the English and American traditions that require poetry to embody and renew itself at the sources of useful language, regardless of how salonesque the end product is to be. Spoken language is very much at the center of values in the English and American traditions. While certain Chinese traditions feature fixing poems in ballad form or in *tzu*, famous song melodies of the past, the locus of value in Chinese poetry is a combination of characters whose usage was perfected before the current author thought of them, actual usages and phrases that fix many characters in the contexts of a detailed, received tradition. So in the works of author upon author, the present is riddled with the parameters of the past and the past receives the present as its due offering. To read is to read the poem from the intimate perspective of the past. May I suggest that the motion of reading in the English and American traditions is one that brings the past forward to elucidate or embellish the present?

The Chinese classical author had a definite idea about life imitating art, and often complained until his did. His art was considered life-regulating, one notch more compelling than consolational, I suppose. He considered ethical and intellectual problems to be solvable in terms of art, also literary art. Certainly the established and successful citizen regarded surrounding himself with arts to be the highest and best privilege and duty. That which art was to be right about certainly included daily living. Westerners, perhaps, misunderstood the frequency and moral sentimentality of the political slogan/poems that are still part of everyday political and social life in China. Mao and Zhou En-lai as poets, too, fit an old, established tradition.

They also had an irresistible notion of art imitating art, especially the folk or popular or antique aspects. The old ballad form from the original *Book of Songs* was never out of fashion, and, in fact, was handled and trusted to give a piece quite venerable respectability. 'The Five Olds,' or five character line also reflected the art

of antiquity. From the Tang poets onward, the poem written to an old and popular tune was a favored method. Su Shi, two-hundred years later, is taken to be the master of that kind of composition, called *tzü*.

The quality of a classical poem depends on its victories in filling the received line and stanza form with tonally balanced progressions and balances, especially in line pairs, and with a finished emotion realized through graceful, continuous allusion to the presence of the past in its recounting. The structural tension is, as usual, between the external form and the sound and sense matters in the text. Because the external form belonged to the past, too, the poem offers a complete sense of being absorbed into what went before. Let me say here that what I find most lacking in those stark free verse renderings referred to before is precisely that they have gotten rid of the outer shell of the poem and give us only a sense of the meanings conveyed, not of the artful business of the poem. They have the informational substance of the text, but not a sense of the poem's artistic whole. Perhaps this is impossible without submitting something like a Procrustean nursery rhyme as finished product, with phrases and allusions stretched out or clipped to fit a line that might sound, in English, a bit attenuated. That's the worst prospect of what we have done, because we have attempted to create a line English very much like the original line in duration and with some attentions to gamesmanship, too. What is missing is the music that once accompanied it, which leaves the poem a sort of aria without orchestra. Tang and Sung melodies I have heard validate our decision to write an English line that would not be right if the essential business of the poem were British or American. We would invite a slower reading of the Su Shi poem than one would give the blank verse texts of Robert Frost or Philip Larkin. In fact, a Su Shi *tzü* especially ought to be rendered and read with a sustained sense of longer line, with more of a sense of parallelism, for instance, like that we associate with Psalm verses. Something vital to their original composition is lost when they are changed into quick, plain line and image artifacts.

2

We decided to represent the salon aspects of Su Shi's work with one English word or small phrase for each Chinese character or phrase, in general. His poems' lines are four, five, six or seven characters in length. I believe we had opportunity to work in all the insinuations and much of the semantic action of the original characters, though I felt obliged to recompose the rather taut and clipped, elliptical flow of the originals as English sentencings. As I have suggested, in Chinese poetry it is as if the cultured mind of the reader supplies to the poem's musical/image suggestion the instrument of rendering.

We hope certain flourishes of language and phrasing in English, along with certain traditional tricks of the trade, such as internal and end rhymes, slant rhymes, alliteration and assonance, will suggest strongly the formality and gracefulnesses of the originals. Some aspects of the originals could not be brought

along into English. Many syllables were chosen for their subtle variations in length and tonal echos. A great many characters and phrases in Chinese poetry allude to their prior occurrences in great old poems. The Chinese concept of Nature includes the harmony between the language and the deepest traditions of personal, family and social order, including the literature of that lore. Certain expressions are beautiful because they have always been part of that Nature.

We took compositional shortcuts to keep the poems from sprawling to include all their original subtleties and allusions and references. We tried to suggest much of this action in the notes and appreciations. Keep in mind the well-trained Chinese reader would bring many of these with him to the act of reading. Indeed, to read is to be reminded of all that has gone into the making of the consciousness in prior artistic experience, which tends to take a sort of historical precedence over ordinary experience because the artist has abdicated his own selfish interests in the act of composition and is therefore the sublime equivalent of the peasant, the learned commoner. Poetry, in this case, is simply the most compressed and preserved cultural expression of all. Perhaps we in English-speaking cultures bring a parallel devotion to our appreciations, but I don't think we think of the great poems as finalizing quests and emotions and difficulties in the same way Chinese intellectuals do.

Our publisher, by the way, The People's Publishing House of Henan Province, up at Zhengzhou, most happily, is going to grant us the sizable favor of printing the original texts (+ pinyin + pinyin + cultural notes + appreciations) so that any reader can try his hand at rendering the poems. In this respect, we think our little volume brings the reader into direct involvement with the business of translating classical Chinese poetry. We hope numerous readers try their hand at it.

3

Both the spirit of composition of Sung Dynasty poetry and the openness with which it addressed the worlds of experience outside courtly and intellectually fashionable matters are remarkable. It was an era that saw expansions in subject matters and a sort of Romantic declaration of the poet's self as the central matter of composition. Su Shi is among the masters of that era. He knew well the poets of the past, Tu Fu, Wen Ting-jun, Yen Hsuan, Li Po, Wang Wei and Po Chu-i. He knew practically by heart the writings of Lao Tzu, and Confucius, and passed government qualifying tests at several levels to prepare himself for government appointment. He would already have internalized the strictures and fashions in composition, the prescriptions and conventions, before he began his career in writing. He was a master of the *tzu* poem, which was a kind of freely constructed lyric. He composed numerous *tzu*, or poems written to the tunes of ancient and popular melodies. He knew and admired the *lu-shih*, or tonally formulated couplet poems, of the T'ang era, eight or twelve line poems featuring end rhymes and lines of five or six characters, and the *chueh-chu*, quatrains made of five to seven character lines, that

were often set to music, too, and, at its best, left the reader suspended among several possible realizations. He knew a great many of the old *yueh-fu*, or folk and common songs. He knew perfectly well the intellectual gravities of Confucian thought, with all its emphases on duties and responsibilities to family, village, and state, and was fascinated by Taoist and Buddhist thought, too, with their emphases on the illusory character of the world and the timelessness of the senses. Especially he knew, as did all scholar-artists, the ancient literary model poems, the *Shih Ching*, or classic songs, compiled before the time of Confucius (the 5th Century B.C.), and the *Ch'u-tzu*, or 'Elegies of Chu,' which are composed rather rhapsodically and filled with sensuous imagery, in five to seven character lines broken with a sort of suspended pause that amounts to a kind of inward sigh, very much like the English language caesura. The subject matters of the 'Nine Songs' are unusually personal. These poems date from the time of the Warring Kingdoms, in the centuries following Confucius. I mean to suggest that Su Shi's originality includes thorough and lively utilization of his very many sources and influences. He was, as were so many before and after him, a scholar-poet, and was required to be when he qualified originally to become an imperial advisor and governor and statesman.

Su Shi was regarded as dealing strongly and creatively with the often closely regarded form of the *tzu*. The texts he wrote take command of the tunes they fit, tradition has it, and represent a masculine virtue utilizing the feminine song. His learning, too, differentiates him from many other practitioners of the art. He made the *tzu* a vehicle from autobiographical as much as fanciful reverie, the usual ground of meaning. He was also a great parodist of current affairs and ideas, an artist in fact who lived his private life in exile without taking his inner eye off events and controversies and individuals affecting his time. These public matters, too, riddle his poems, along with their learned and artistic concerns. Keep in mind his 'readers' too would have been people much like himself, courtly or learned, a very small group of famous persons who viewed society and history through Confucian masks of advantage.

4

Su Shi was a native of Meishan, in what is now Sichuan Province. He was a beneficiary of the somewhat enlightened policy of the emperor, former military, heroic figure General Chou, who ordered elaborate systems of cultural tests be given to find the best artistic and philosophical minds to advise and govern the empire. Both Su Shi and his brother Su Che did well on the tests, largely because their father, also a notable scholar, Su Hsun, saw to it the boys were well prepared. The tests covered the entire of the culture's famous past and fewer than ten per cent of the takers passed. Examinees were asked about the histories of the usages of certain key words and phrases, and were asked to differentiate between numerous literary styles. They had to display comprehension of the aesthetic issues and

their priorities in the arts of the past. These matters were deemed important for judging the law and policies of the government. I mention these to suggest the matter of life imitating art also in official thinking.

Su Shi (1037–1101) came to the capital during the administration of Wang An-shih (1021–1086), who served as prime minister. He was called 'the bull-headed' for his determination to shore up the nation's failing agricultural economy with what came to be called 'The New Law', or 'The Green Law', in Chinese, the *Ching-miao-fa*, which lent moneys to farmers in bad years, assessed taxes according to land productivity, allowed farmers to pay taxes in cash and sell crops locally, and worst of all, taxed wealthy absentee landlords more than local farmers. Su Shi, when he arrived at court, took the side of those who thought it dangerous for the throne to be engaged in business better left to the provinces and villages. Does the Emperor wish to be found, Su Shi wrote, peddling coal and ice and grain like any greedy merchant? (One sees a bit of the Confucian disdain for business in the remark.) It cost him his popularity at court, and nearly his life. Perhaps because of his father's reputation, perhaps because he was so young and learned and new at court, he was banished instead, in 1080, to Huang Chou, in what is now Huangang County of Hubei Province. When he returned to the capital, in 1085, he had met the ousted Prime Minister and admitted his error and come around to the imperial policy, only to find that policy was now quite out of favor. And besides, he spoke openly and sharply about the corrupt officials out in the countryside, who administered the laws unfairly. He took the peasants' views about the national government. So he was banished again, and this time it was as good as for good. He spent his entire career in provincial government posts, Suzhou, Huizhou, Zhangzhou, and finally desolate Hainan, from which he returned to the capital, in 1101, to retire, at sixty-six. He was no less humble and demanding about the honor of the peasants, with whom the scholar-artist had spent most of his life. He escaped the life at court, with its myriad rules and rigid prescriptions of gestures and addresses, and instead fished and farmed alongside ordinary people of his day, regarded them as intimates, and became dear to them and their descendants.

The Rule of Heaven turned out to be in his day the rule of men who thought he took his Confucian pieties too zealously and his Taoist and Buddhist humors too literally. And he spent a lifetime writing against pretense, intellectual literal-mindedness and injustice.

5

He left the world his journals, seventeen-hundred poems, and more than eight-hundred private letters, so the man had his say. He is also one of the great calligraphers. His social criticism is enough to be a feature of study. Often this took the form of satire. In one such piece he assaults the Confucian tendency to see issues prescriptively and proscriptively. He employs what we must see as a bit of Taoist humor:

One blind man from birth has no conception of the sun. If one day he questions someone about the sun, he is told, 'The sun is like a brass basin.' Then he knocks against a basin and hears it clang, and later takes a bell for the sun. So another man tells him, 'The sun-light is like a candle.' Then he feels a candle to discover its shape, and later takes a flute for the sun. The sun is very different from bells and flutes, but a blind man does not know this because he has never seen it — he goes by hearsay.

Now the Way is more difficult to discern than the sun, and those who do not study are like blind men. So when one who knows the way speaks of it, even though he is skilled in making apt comparisons, he can think of nothing better than a basin or a candle; though a basin may make his hearer think of a bell, a candle of a flute, until the hearer gets farther and farther from the truth. Thus when men talk of the Way, they attempt to describe it in terms of what they have seen, or imagine it without having seen it, and both cases they deviate from the Way.

One sees in these remarks not only a presentation of certain Taoist perspectives but also a kind of apology, defining the territories of figurative thought and poetic language, strongest when least definitive, when most allusive and suggestive without becoming programmatic.

Su Shi influenced literary developments in poetry in both the matters of subject and style. His poems quite often present the most accurate and intimate details of ordinary living, add those to the accumulated and almost exclusively courtly matters taken as legitimate in times past. He writes of harrassed peasant women working their farms for primarily tax collectors' gains, of a famously crooked sheriff, made into a corpse-candle by the peasants, of old fishing and drinking buddies in straw capes, cleaning their nets and hanging them out to dry, of wonderful festivals in remote villages, of pretty local girls and their lucky husbands. If the fashions in writing that prevailed in his day featured courtly goings-on, sentimental romance, and something like the clichés of Petrarchan art as essential to literary performances, Su Shi's sympathies and consolations and pleasures were found among those living the old, village life. He returned to the subject values of Li Po, the great T'ang poet. His one continuing theme was that honorable men must suffer the world a good deal.

He wrote many nature lyrics, in which he described moments of peace and satisfaction in that changeless world. He was a master at finding an emblem in nature to name the struggle of his inner life, in a lonely swan-geese's coming to rest in the cold sand in the brush by a wintered river, in the first reappearance of a globefish in springtime, when the soul felt wintered-out. In his emotional frankness he reminds us of certain modern poets, beginning with Wordsworth. The virility of his style reminds of Byron.

In some respects Su Shi strikes us as nearly modern, with his sense of irony, his sense of alienation, and his colloquial frankness. Certainly he democratized the *tzu* poem, and gave it new dimensions of a directly autobiographical character. He

and Huang Ting-jian are credited with having founded the 'Jiangxi School,' sometimes called the 'Su-Huang School,' characterized by direct, personal, and colloquial gestures in poetry. He gave literary substance to what had been more often than not a kind of artful palace dalliance, and explored its lyrical and satirical applications. He continues to be a favorite for those who prefer to break down the distances between the remote emotions of those who rule and the feelings of ordinary people who are ruled. Though he was the well-trained Confucian intellectual, he lived much of his life as the Buddhist *chüssü*, or wandering mystic. The old master took his literary name from the East Hill that he made into his farm, near Huangzhou, in honor of his life in an out-of-the-way place among out-of-the-way people: Su Tung-p'ō. His pride and his talent made a great and important literature out of that obscurity.

6

It's not possible to enter upon a project of translating Chinese poetry without Ezra Pound historically looking over one's shoulder to ask what kind of attention one is paying to the nature of the original Chinese characters. In his rather fine essay in the introduction of the Penguin Anthology *New Songs from a Jade Terrace*, J.H. Prynne reminds us Pound had a literary program in mind, to substantiate the Imagists' interest in 'an absolute metaphor,' one that did more than allude to historical and symbolic matters, that embodied actual, living realization. It would seem to me Pound and the others were trying to shake-off the attendant implications that surrounded PreRaphaelite and Georgian imagery, poetics that alluded to the senses more than they recreated them. They alluded to literary culture, instead. Indeed, Pound wished to adopt Ernest Fenollosa's observations about *The Chinese Written Character as a Medium for Poetry* to his program for reforming verse, away from rhyme, metrical regularity, and from emotional self-consciousness. He saw in the ideogram a suddenly total revelation instead of a contemplative address. Anglo-American Modernism owes everything to his utilizations in *Cathay*. I would like to remind, however, that his translations are utilizations, and, as such, leave out or minimize, other aspects of Chinese poetics that are just as real, or just as important, in the original texts.

Pound saw each character as subsuming everything in an emotional intellection, as revelation. Each character is a world, as we have all read in his famous notes and rendering of 'The Jewelled Stairs Grievance.' Each represents a direct treatment, an 'absolute metaphor,' as Prynne calls it. Pound even gets rid of footnotes and explanations of historical allusions, explanations of puns, cultural metonymies, all the implied business of the singular characters. Certainly poetry in English needed to unload its spiritual sentimentality and post-Romantic self-indulgences. It needed a model that cut cleaner to the bone, perhaps one that got rid of the idea of culture itself as mediating individual experience. I want to defend Pound's taste in my own way even as I say his choices omitted the

consideration of that which would certainly have militated against the poetic he wanted to describe, that he found and admired in the Chinese and urged upon the Imagists in London.

But Chinese ideograms do not embody only or even mainly such action. They do not allude primarily to the senses. To read a Chinese character is to find what it names released from actual time into literary time, so to speak. Where the Chinese poet names events in nature as reflecting his spirit or emotion, it is to be understood that the Nature he is implying is the inherited, highly developed literary language of the culture. Indeed his characters and phrases quite often allude directly to prior literary occasions, as Prynne's essay demonstrates. There is a single metonymy operating in classical Chinese poetry and it is the past of its literature and history. The image/character breathes, to be sure, *in* with the poet's immediate experience (and Pound used that aspect as he wanted to), and the image/character also breathes *out* and that action occurs because the expression has been translated into a language dialect set aside by an old hierarchical art for that purpose. Only those trained in the art, after all, can read classical Chinese poetry; does that sound like the direct and democratic energy Pound wished to use?

Add to this that line lengths, 'The Five Olds,' heptasyllabic, etcetera, are traditional forms, along with, of course, the old tunes of the sing-song ladies. The rhetorical shapes of poems and their rhythmical characteristics and dimensions are rather declared from the outside. Their forms are organic vis-à-vis a good deal of preceding work. The relation between the tensions of the external form and the internal flow of tonal and image senses cannot be set aside without inventing a sort of loose, indeed, (for lack of a better word) democratized version of the old poems. Originally, their very meanings are bound up with restriction, like the weaving Yeats refers to and Robert Frost's tennis net, without which he simply refused to play.

This is not to bash Pound for taking what he needed to exemplify what he wanted. Even though I think William Carlos Williams wrote more in the spirit of Chinese ideograms than Pound (and so did Hilda Doolittle), Pound's borrowings now seem essential for what needed to come after, a poetry without a decorative sense of expression.

We found that by extending the line sense to include the same number of beats or words as the originals we were able to create an equivalent poem of yet another kind. We were able to include or imply certain of the baroque matters of the originals. We felt that another and just as real appreciation of Chinese verse, however sparse its denotative signals, presented an occasion for cultural reading, for baroque appreciation, in fact. The original verse is not minimal, in fact, except to the devices of another language. Have not recent opinions about texts in English turned to their layers of content, to seeing how the simplest texts implicate a good deal of cultural savvy and semiotic suggestion? Multiple readings are possible of an artful text and even informal or accidental texts bear considerable fruits in analysis as artifacts.

Our renderings tried to keep some of the cultural suggestions of the originals,

and to hold the English versions to the formality of the primary texts, too. What one gets is a different sounding poem, to be sure, one that appears to be held to a form that precedes it, within which it narrates and suggests as much as possible. Pound was right: a character contains worlds of metonymy, not worlds of *symbol* only, or even mainly. For the metonymies are stylized allusions; worlds of cultural suggestion, historical pre-usage, elegantly shaded allegory of episodes and persons are implicated, as is a consciousness taken as the domain of art. Perhaps, at the center of the matter, that is what led us to want to try for another representation of Chinese poetry. Which is not to say that spending rainy Sunday afternoons and evenings with the old Sung master Su Tung-p'o was not a splendid trip into his world and times, because we had a lovely time doing it. Once I even lay down on the his stone bed, where he drank and toasted the moon, at Huangzhou's 'Red Cliff.' I wouldn't trade the experiences for anything, even if the results of our labors turned out to be interesting failures that, at best, inspired still other efforts to get the translations right.

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Notes on the Chinese Names

The Wade-Giles system of Romanization is used in the case of names which have to some extent gained currency in the West in that form. Otherwise *pinyin* forms are used.

<i>Chinese characters</i>	<i>Wade-Giles</i>	<i>Pinyin</i>
蘇東坡	Su Tung-p'o	Su Dongpo
宋	Sung	Song
蘇軾	Su Shih	Su Shi
詞	tz'ü	ci
毛	Mao	Mao
周恩來	Chou Ên-lai	Zhou Enlai
河南	Honan	Henan
老子	Laotzu	Laozi
鄭州	Chengchou	Zhengzhou
杜甫	Tu Fu	Du Fu
溫庭筠	Wên T'ing-yün	Wen Tingjun
李白	Li Po	Li Bai
王維	Wang Wei	Wang Wei
白居易	Po Chü-i	Bai Juyi
唐	T'ang	Tang
律詩	lū-shih	lǜ shi
絕句	chüch-chü	jue ju
樂府	yüeh-fu	yue fu
楚辭	Ch'u-tz'u	Chu ci
四川	Szech'uan	Sichuan
周	Chou	Zhou
眉山	Meishan	Meishan
蘇轍	Su Ch'ê	Su Zhe
蘇洵	Su Hsün	Su Xun
王安石	Wang An-shih	Wang Anshi
青苗法	Ch'ing-miao-fa	Qingmiao fa
江西	Kiangsi	Jiangxi
蘇州	Soochou	Suzhou

<i>Chinese characters</i>	<i>Wade-Giles</i>	<i>Pinyin</i>
惠州	Huichou	Huizhou
樟州	Changchou	Zhangzhou
黃州	Huangchou	Huangzhou
海南	Hainan	Hainan
道	Tao	Dao
蘇黃	Su-Huang	Su-Huang
黃庭堅	Huang T'ing-chien	Huang Tingjian

